Oosterdam: Barcelona to Athens in the Steps of Paul

7 Nights · August 28 to September 4, 2027

Ship: Oosterdam, Holland America Line · **From:** Barcelona · **To:** Piraeus (Athens) · **Cabin:** _____ **Group:** Salem Media's Deeper Faith Mediterranean Cruise with Alistair Begg · Inspiration Travel 800-247-1899

A condensed Voyage Pack from In the Wake: the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers the ship, each port, Paul at each stop, packing, budget, emergency contacts and Medicare.

Day by day

Dates and ports are from the group's brochure ("All dates and locations subject to change"). **Holland America hasn't published port times this pack could read.** They'll be in your booking, the app and the ship's daily program. Be back aboard by the all-aboard time printed there.

#	Date	Port	Paul here	Worth knowing
1	Sat Aug 28	**Barcelona: boarding**	Romans 15:24, 28. Paul planned to come to Spain; Scripture doesn't say he did.	Fly in a day early. The State Department says airport taxis to the cruise terminal charge a flat fee.
2	Sun Aug 29	At sea	Read Acts 27:1-12	Holland America holds an interdenominational service Sunday mornings.
3	Mon Aug 30	**Valletta, Malta**	Acts 27:39 to 28:11. The shipwreck, the viper, Publius.	Euro. Ask your group what's open that day.
4	Tue Aug 31	At sea	Acts 27:13-38. The storm, in the water you're crossing.	A quiet day.
5	Wed Sep 1	**Souda (Chania), Crete**	Acts 27:7-21; Titus 1:5. Souda isn't Fair Havens.	Euro. The group or ship will say how to get into Chania.
6	Thu Sep 2	**Mykonos**	No Bible link.	Euro. Rest your feet before Ephesus. Check the daily program for dock or tender.
7	Fri Sep 3	**Kusadasi (Ephesus), Turkey**	Acts 19; 20:17-38; Ephesians; Revelation 2:1-7.	**The group's Ephesus excursion.** Theatre, Agora, Library of Celsus (Turkey's Ministry of Culture). Hot: Aydın province averages about 97°F in August. Old stone; shoes with grip, water, a hat.
8	Sat Sep 4	**Piraeus (Athens): leave the ship**	Acts 17:15-34. Paul on Mars' hill.	Euro. Ask Inspiration Travel about transfers. Check the Acropolis hours on Greece's Ministry of Culture site if you stay on.

Getting to the ship and getting home

- **Fly into Barcelona a day early.** Inspiration Travel offers flight and hotel quotes and pier transfers.
- **Fly home from Athens.** Holland America hasn't published the arrival time yet, and it will tell you when you can leave the ship. Don't book a tight flight.
- **Passports.** The State Department recommends six months of validity for Greece, and Turkey requires passports "valid for six months beyond your entry date." Make sure yours runs well past March 2028.
- **No visa needed** for US citizens on this trip, per the State Department: up to 90 days in Spain, Malta and Greece (Schengen), and up to 90 days in any 180 in Turkey.

Money and what costs extra

- **Fare:** the brochure's "starting at $2,958" a person, two to a cabin, includes cruise fare and government taxes and fees. **Air isn't included.** $50 off a person for booking online.
- **Crew Appreciation:** $18 a person a day in a standard cabin, $20 in a suite (Holland America FAQ). About **$126 a person** for the week. Ask Inspiration Travel if your package includes it.
- **Aboard:** US dollars. **Ashore:** euro in Spain, Malta and Greece. Turkey isn't on the euro; cards work at most tourist places.
- **Extra:** drinks, specialty dining, spa, Wi-Fi, laundry (no self-service), other excursions.

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Medicare: read this twice

Medicare's own guide: "Medicare doesn't cover health care services you get when the ship is more than 6 hours away from a U.S. port," and "Medicare plans can't cover drugs you buy outside the U.S." **Ask about a travel medical policy, with medical evacuation, before you go.** The ship's medical center has doctors and nurses on call 24/7 for urgent care, and it bills you.

Getting on and off

Holland America says every ship except Volendam and Zaandam, so Oosterdam too, has an elevator to the tender platform. Gangways can be steep at low or high tide, and the captain decides whether it's safe to help a guest ashore. Tell Inspiration Travel about mobility needs when you book.

Travel advisories (read November 2026)

Spain Level 2 · Malta Level 1 · Greece Level 1 · Turkey Level 2 (its "do not travel" area is the Syria and Iraq border region). These describe November 2026, not your sailing week. They change both ways. Check again the week before.

Emergency numbers

- **Ashore:** 112 in Spain, Malta and Greece (EU). In Turkey, 155 for police.
- **US State Department, 24/7:** +1 (888) 407-4747 from the US, +1 (202) 501-4444 from abroad.
- **US embassies:** Madrid +34 91-587-2200 (Barcelona consulate +34 93-280-2227) · Malta +356 2561-4000 · Athens +30 210-721-2951 · Ankara +90 312-294-0000.
- **Holland America (from the US):** 1-800-426-0327 business hours (Pacific), 1-800-628-4771 after hours, 1-206-626-7382 critical emergencies only.

The full pack has the fillable handoff card. Numbers checked November 2026. Check them again before you go. Soli Deo Gloria.

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